

SCIENCE

Loyola, Chennai, once again emerges as the winner. Stephen's, Delhi, and Presidency, Kolkata, move up. Joseph's, Bangalore, is among the toppers.

TOP 10 COLLEGES

2008		2007	2006
1	Loyola College, Chennai	1	1
2	St Stephen's College, Delhi	4	5
3	Presidency College, Kolkata	8	4
4	St Xavier's College, Mumbai	5	2
5	St Xavier's College, Kolkata	2	8
6	Presidency College, Chennai	7	3
7	Fergusson College, Pune	9	6
8	Christ College, Bangalore	10	10
9	Madras Christian College, Chennai	6	-
NEW 10	St Joseph's College, Bangalore	-	-

National rankings are derived from a combination of perceptual and factual scores. Colleges that did not provide factual information were not ranked.
 * New entrants in the Top 10. (-) Not ranked in the Top 10.

■ By S. Senthil Kumar

With Loyola College retaining its first position in the science stream in this year's survey, there has been no surprise in the top slot. However, there have been some big gainers and losers in the top 10 bracket as St. Stephen's, Delhi, and Presidency College, Kolkata, move up to second and third places from No. 4



and No. 8, respectively, last year.

The biggest drop in the top 10 has been of St. Xavier's, Ahmedabad, which has slipped from No. 3 last year to No. 13 this year. This fall has primarily been due to the low overall score of the college at No. 25. Another college which has lost out heavily in overall ranking is Hindu College (No. 11 to No. 21), the result of a poor perceptual rating at No. 32.

The snake-and-ladder movements apart, the toppers in the science stream have much to talk about while laying claim to their distinguished positions. Loyola, for instance, has everything an aspiring science graduate could ask for. Spread over 99 acres with a lush green cover of more than 300 trees of 50 different species, the college campus itself can serve as a study in bio-diversity.

Though quality research is the prerogative of universities in India, Loyola as an autonomous institution

contributes to the knowledge pool with its critical body of research every year. The introduction of rare courses like plant bio-technology, advanced zoology and visual communication is no coincidence but the result of carefully weighed options.

An institution that stresses on research with a social relevance, Loyola has been quick to come up with solutions that come to the aid of society during crises. For example, it provided high-tech solutions for the Chennai Corporation to curb the spread of water-borne diseases during heavy rains. Dr S. Vincent, faculty at the Department of Advanced Zoology and Bio-technology, led representatives of Madras University and the Chennai Corporation in identifying choked storm water drains in low-lying areas, using the geographic information system (GPS). A Rs 50 lakh grant was provided